Scott Atkins

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Software Engineer | Android & Rust
Technology is only as strong as the people behind it.

Education

BS in Computer Science
University of Minnesota, Institute of Technology

Skills

Languages / Platforms / Tools
Rust, Java, Kotlin, Android, AI-Assisted Engineering (Claude, LLM Tooling)

Experience

Amazon - *Software Development Engineer*
Dec. 2016 - Present

- Built and launched a native middleware platform for FireTV. Built tools and infrastructure in Rust and Java, bridged Java Android APIs with native components, and guided partner teams to rewrite Java services in Rust, cutting memory usage and crashes by 80%+.
- Architected an IPC tool to facilitate communication between Rust and Android processes using AIDL. Adopted by 15+ partner teams across FireTV, cutting team onboarding times from weeks to days.
- Helped build and scale the Amazon Relay logistics Android application from inception to tens of thousands of active users. Designed critical modular workflows in Kotlin, including commercial navigation, barcode scanning, and route execution.
- Reduced ANRs in my team's Android service by 90%.
- Leveraged AI-assisted development workflows to refactor mission-critical legacy systems and more than double unit test code coverage.
- Built an internal web tool to streamline Amazon Relay driver messaging, transforming a manual, error-prone engineer task into an automated self-service system.
- Mentored junior engineers and interns on system design, unit testing best practices, and code architecture.
- Developed a patented method of converting Java bytecode into LLVM IR, enabling native binary compilation.

SmartThings, Samsung - *Software Engineer*
Sept. 2012 - Nov. 2016

- Worked directly with company founders to build and launch the initial SmartThings iOS application, driving platform growth that ultimately led to acquisition by Samsung.
- Transitioned to a role on the Android team as engineer and Scrum Master, building feature parity between platforms and implementing smart device pairing, app-to-backend communications, and livestream video support on the SmartThings Android application.

Digital Cyclone, Garmin - *Software Engineer*
Mar. 2008 - Aug. 2012

- Built a vector-based aviation map on iOS using Objective-C and OpenGL, laying the foundation for what evolved into Garmin Pilot.
- Developed and deployed an Android augmented reality weather application featured at CES.
- Designed and delivered My-Cast Weather to the Google Play Store, and optimized C++ ports for Windows Mobile.

Destineer Studios - *Gameplay Programmer*
Mar. 2007 - Feb. 2008

- Engineered gameplay systems for Six Days in Fallujah (PC/Xbox). Implemented resource preloading to eliminate in-game level stutter and created scene-summary tools for designers.

Microsoft - *Software Developer in Test*
Aug. 2006 - Feb. 2007

- Wrote automated test suites to validate print spooler functionality within Windows.

Featured Personal Projects

Cards Android Project
Feb. 2021 - Present

- Built and deployed an open source multi-module Android project sharing logic and UX across three production applications on Google Play: Comlink, Ringlore, and Combadge.
- Reached thousands of downloads with a 4.8 lifetime rating across the suite.

Stats for Dota 2
Feb. 2014 - Present

- Designed, deployed, and maintained Stats for Dota 2, an Android statistics application serving 1,600 daily active users with 2,400+ reviews and a 4.7 lifetime rating.
- Performed modernizations across codebases, migrating from Holo to Material Design, Java to Kotlin, and RxJava to Kotlin Coroutines.